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Family

Ready for whatever comes.

The Family Bidding Kit

The fair way for siblings to divide a loved one's
personal property — without fighting.

KEY FACTS AT A GLANCE

What it is: A step-by-step bidding system for dividing personal property fairly.

Who it's for: Executors and families splitting a loved one's belongings among heirs.

How long it takes: One weekend to inventory. Two weeks to bid. One afternoon to close out.

What you get: The full method, a worked example, and six fillable forms.

By Bill Morton · EverReady Family

An organizational tool. Not legal advice, not tax advice.
everready-family.com



A note from Bill

My name is Bill Morton. A few years back, my mother passed away and I became the executor of her estate.

Our family was spread across the country. And my mom — bless her — was a **collector**. So this wasn't three rooms of furniture. It was a house full of things, and every one of them had somebody in the family with an eye on it.

Everyone agreed on two things: they wanted it dealt with **fast**, and they didn't want to fight about it. But with that many items and that many heirs in that many states, fighting is exactly what usually happens. I'd watched it happen in other families. I wasn't going to watch it happen in mine.

So I built a system. I photographed **every single item**, gave each one a number, and put the whole list up where the whole family could see it. Then everybody **bid on what they wanted** — openly, in writing, where the whole family could see every bid, with a deadline. Highest bid won. When the bidding closed, each person's winning bids were **deducted from their share** of the estate, and I published every number to everybody.

It worked exceptionally well. There was almost no arguing — because there was nothing to argue about. The rules were the same for everybody, the numbers were visible to everybody, and **if someone really wanted an item, they could get it**. That's the whole trick, and it's the reason this kit exists.

Most estate fights aren't about money. They're about feeling like the process wasn't fair. This kit is the process I ran, written down step by step, so you don't have to invent it while you're grieving. I've sat in the chair you're sitting in. Let's do this right.

Two promises about this kit

First: everything is in plain English, in the order you'll actually need it. Second: this kit organizes the job — it does not replace a lawyer. Where the law gets sharp, I'll tell you plainly to call one. That's not a dodge; it's the most honest advice in this book.



How to use this kit

You don't need to read this cover to cover before you start. Here's the path:

1. **Read Sections 1 and 2** (about 20 minutes). They explain why families fight and exactly how the bidding method works. Everything else hangs off these.
2. **Skim Section 3** (the rules that prevent fights) and **Section 4** (the worked example with real numbers). The example is worth your time — you'll see the whole system play out in about five minutes.
3. **Inventory the property** using the inventory sheet. Nothing gets bid on, claimed, or removed until every item is photographed, numbered, and on the list.
4. **Send the rules in writing, then run the bidding.** Two weeks, open bids posted where everyone can see them, one deadline. The forms in the back do the record-keeping.
5. **Close out** with the results sheet and the signed distribution agreement. Every heir gets a copy of every number.

The six forms in this kit

The forms live at the back of the kit, ready to fill in on screen or print. They carry **no branding** — the header space is yours, for your own logo or letterhead. They are numbered here, and only here:

1. **Item inventory sheet** — lot number, description, photo reference, condition, estimated value, notes.
2. **Per-heir credit ledger** — each heir's bidding credits: issued, spent per round, remaining.
3. **Round bid sheets** — open bids, posted for every heir to see. One sheet per heir per round.
4. **Results and tally sheet** — who won what, for how many credits, tie-breaks noted.
5. **Final distribution agreement** — what each heir received, signed by everyone.
6. **Disputed-claims log** — “Mom promised me that” claims, evidence, and resolutions, in writing.

The one rule underneath everything

Write everything down, show your work to everybody, and treat every heir exactly the same. Nine out of ten estate fights are about fairness of process, not dollars. A transparent process everyone can see is worth more than a perfect one nobody understands.

Why families fight over stuff

It's never about the lamp

In thirty years of watching families settle estates — and then doing it myself — I've learned one thing cold: **the fight is never about the object**. Nobody goes to war over a lamp. They go to war over what the lamp means.

The lamp is who Mom loved more. The cedar chest is who showed up when Dad was sick and who didn't. The ring is thirty years of feeling like the second-place child, finally with a dollar amount attached. Grief turns every object into a symbol, and symbols don't have price tags — which is exactly why dividing them feels impossible.

Say this out loud before you start, because it changes how you run everything after: **grief plus money equals conflict**. Not because your family is broken. Because they're grieving, exhausted, and being asked to put values on things that were never about value. That's a normal family, not a bad one.

What actually causes the fight

It's not greed. In almost every family blowup I've seen, the trigger was one of these four — and three of them have nothing to do with money:

1. **Feeling the process was unfair.** This is the big one. People will accept losing an item they wanted. They will not accept feeling the game was rigged — that someone got early access, or a quiet side deal, or the executor's ear. **Perceived unfairness causes more fights than actual dollar losses, by a mile.**
2. **Ambiguity.** "Mom wanted me to have the painting" — said by two siblings about the same painting. When nothing is written down, every memory is sincerely believed and half of them conflict. Ambiguity doesn't cause disagreements; it causes *certainties* that collide.

3. **Being left out of the process.** The out-of-town sibling who hears about decisions after they're made. The younger sibling who gets informed instead of consulted. People don't need to win — they need to be **in the room**, even if the room is an email thread.
4. **Old scores, new venue.** The estate becomes the place where thirty years of sibling dynamics get settled. You can't fix that. But you **can** build a process so airtight that old scores have nowhere to attach — because every decision was made by the rules, in the open.

Why the usual approaches fail

Families almost always try one of these first. All four fail for the same reason: they ask grieving people to negotiate with each other, face to face, over symbols.

- **Taking turns picking.** Sounds fair. Isn't. The first pick is worth more than the tenth pick, and everybody knows it — so the fight just moves to who picks first. By round three, someone is keeping score, and by round five, someone is crying.
- **Letting the executor decide.** Now every decision has a villain: you. Give the clock to your sister and your brother will remember it at every holiday for a decade. No executor survives being the decider.
- **"Work it out among yourselves."** The loudest voice wins, the quietest resents, and the one who lives closest quietly takes things before anyone notices. This isn't a process; it's an abdication.
- **First come, first served.** Rewards proximity, punishes the sibling three states away. Guarantees the exact unfairness blowup you're trying to avoid.

What actually works

A process everyone can see, the same rules for everyone, and a real way to get the thing you truly want. That's it. That's the whole list. The bidding method in the next section is just those three ideas with paperwork — but the paperwork is what makes them real, because unwritten fairness is just another opinion.



The method, step by step

Seven steps. Each one exists because skipping it caused a specific fight in a specific family — some of them mine. Follow them in order.

Step 1 — Inventory everything, with photos and lot numbers

Nothing is bid on, claimed, or removed until every item is photographed, numbered, and on the list. Say it to the family in writing on day one. This single rule prevents more fights than everything else in this book combined — because once an item is gone, nobody can prove what it was, what condition it was in, or who took it.

- 1. Work room by room, in order.** Start at the front door and move through the house the same way every time — clockwise, say. Finish a room before starting the next. Don't bounce around.
- 2. Give every item a lot number as you go.** Simple system: LOT-001, LOT-002, straight through. Write the number on a sticky note and put it in the photo. Lot numbers are the language the whole process speaks — every bid sheet, every result, every argument refers to lot numbers, not 'the blue vase.'
- 3. Photograph each item three ways:** the lot number clearly visible, one overall shot, and one close-up of any damage, maker's marks, or signatures. A phone camera is fine — this is documentation, not art.
- 4. Write a one-line condition note** for anything that isn't obviously fine: 'scratch on left side,' 'works,' 'untested,' 'missing knob.' Honest condition notes are what make the bidding fair later — nobody should win an item and discover the damage afterward.
- 5. Group the smalls.** You do not need 400 separate entries for kitchen utensils. One entry — 'LOT-014: box of kitchen utensils, ~30 pieces' — with one photo of the box open. Save individual entries for things someone might actually bid on.
- 6. Handle the special categories separately:** firearms (check your state's transfer rules before moving them), prescription medications (pharmacy take-back — never the trash), cash and jewelry (log immediately, photograph, lock up), and important papers (to a locked box, untouched).

Use the **item inventory sheet** at the back of this kit — one row per lot. Print as many copies as you need, or fill it in on screen.



Step 2 — Give every heir an equal bank of bidding credits

Every heir gets **1,000 bidding credits**. Same number, no exceptions, no adjustments for who visited more or who needs it more. Credits are not money — they're a claim on the pile of belongings, and everyone holds an equal claim.

The fairness math, plainly stated

Here's why equal banks are fair even when the items aren't equal: **nobody is entitled to any particular item**. Each heir is entitled to an equal **share of bidding power**. If you spend 650 of your 1,000 credits on the grandfather clock, that's your choice — you valued it at 650, and nobody else was willing to pay more. The sibling who spent 80 credits on the rocking chair valued **that** at 80. Both got exactly what they were willing to pay for, with the same money everyone else had.

Think of it like an auction where every bidder walks in with the same amount of cash. Nobody can say the outcome was rigged, because everyone could have bid on anything. The results reflect what each person actually wanted — not who argued best, not who the executor liked most.

What if the shares aren't equal?

Most families divide personal property equally even when the will splits money unevenly — check the will first. If the will genuinely gives unequal shares of the **personal property**, scale the credit banks to match: a 50/30/20 split becomes 1,000 / 600 / 400 credits. The math still works. What's not fair is equal credits against unequal entitlements, so match the banks to the shares and say so in the written rules.

Record each heir's bank on the **per-heir credit ledger**. Credits unspent at the end simply expire — they're bidding currency, not cash value, and they don't convert to money.

Step 3 — Open-bid rounds on the items that matter

Publish the full inventory — photos, lot numbers, descriptions, condition notes — where **every heir can see it at the same time**. A shared photo folder plus a spreadsheet works. A simple website works. What matters is simultaneity: no early access, no side lists, nobody sees it before anyone else.

Then send the rules **in writing, before bidding opens**. Everyone gets the same message. It should say:

- **The bidding window:** two weeks from the day the list goes live. One deadline, published up front. No extensions — extensions are where fairness goes to die, because they reward the strategic and punish the prompt.
- **Open bids, posted where every heir can see them.** Every bid goes on the family board — a shared sheet, a group thread, a printed list on the fridge — with the bidder's name on it, the day it comes in. Open bids mean nobody bids blind: every heir sees every bid, so each person has a fair shot at every item, and nobody loses something they truly wanted because they guessed too low. And because every bid is visible to everyone, nobody can claim a quiet side deal decided anything.
- **Bid what it's worth to you — and you can raise.** There are no minimums on ordinary household items. You can see the standing high bid on every lot, so you always know what it takes to win the cedar chest — and if someone tops you before the deadline, you decide whether it's worth more. Bid in whole credits.
- **You don't have to bid on everything.** Bid only on what you actually want. Unbid items go to the second-chance round (Step 6).
- **The tie-break rule** (Step 5) — stated now, before anyone bids, so nobody can claim it was invented to favor someone.
- **What winning costs:** your winning bids are deducted from your credit bank (Step 4), and — if the family is also splitting cash — from your cash share. One transparent line on the final accounting.

Bids go on the **round bid sheets** — one sheet per heir per round — and the executor posts each sheet where every heir can see it, the day it arrives. The posted sheets are the public record: every bid, every bidder, every standing high. The executor also confirms each bid in writing to the bidder, so no one can later say 'I sent a bid and you lost it.'

Step 4 — Highest bid wins; credits deducted

When the deadline passes, bidding freezes. Each lot goes to the heir whose bid stands highest on the board, and the executor deducts the winning bid from that heir's credit bank. Then — this is the part that makes it permanent — **the executor publishes the final results to every heir at the same time:** every lot, every winner, every winning bid. Nobody hears it secondhand, and nobody can say the numbers changed after the fact.

Sunlight is the system. When everyone can see that the clock went to Dan for 650 because Mara bid 400 and Priya bid 100, there is nothing to argue about. Dan didn't get *given* the clock. He *paid* more for it than anyone else would. That's a fact, in writing, visible to all.



Record results on the **results and tally sheet**, and update each heir's remaining credits on the **credit ledger**. If winning bids also come off cash shares, that deduction appears as one line per heir on the final accounting — same number everyone already saw on the results sheet.

Step 5 — Tie-breaking rules

Ties happen. Decide the rule **before bidding opens** and put it in the written rules. The standard sequence:

1. **Open tie-break round**, 48 hours, between the tied bidders only, on that lot only — every raise posted on the board like any other bid. Minimum raise: 10 credits, so nobody ties again at the same number out of politeness.
2. **Still tied? Draw lots**, witnessed — the executor draws in front of (or on video with) the tied bidders. It feels old-fashioned. It is also unarguable, which is the entire point.

Never break a tie by executor's choice, by seniority, by 'who needs it more,' or by who asked first. Every one of those is a judgment call, and judgment calls are what you're eliminating.

Step 6 — Leftover items: second chance, then donate or sell

After Round 1, some lots will have no bids — the heavy dining table nobody wants to move, the box of linens, the third bookshelf. That's normal, not a failure.

1. **Second-chance round (one week)**. The executor lists the unclaimed lots. Any heir may claim any lot for a nominal bid — even 1 credit — first-come, first-served by timestamp, or by mini-bid if two heirs want the same lot. Heirs who sat out Round 1 may join here.
2. **What still remains gets sold or donated**. Estate sale, auction, or consignment for anything salable; donation for the rest. **Proceeds are split equally among the heirs** (or per the will's shares — state it in the rules). Get donation receipts in every heir's name or split the tax receipt value the same way.
3. **Price the leftovers to move**. The goal was never top dollar on every spoon. It was a fair process and a cleared house. Every month of storage costs the family more than the leftover linens are worth.

Step 7 — The executor runs the auction

The executor is the auctioneer: publishes the list, sends the rules, posts every bid where everyone can see it, enforces the deadline, publishes the results, keeps the records. Neutral, boring, meticulous — the best auctioneer is the one nobody notices. Section 5 covers the role and its boundaries in full, because this is where executors get into trouble.

Why this kept my family from fighting

My mother collected for decades. Hundreds of items, heirs in several states. After bidding closed, I sent everyone the full results and the accounting — item, winner, winning bid, every number. I braced for the phone calls. They never came. When people can see the rules, see the bids, and see the math — and when anyone who truly wanted something could simply bid for it — there's nothing left to fight about. That's not luck. That's design.

Rules that prevent fights

The method is the engine. These rules are the guardrails. Each one exists because its absence caused a real fight in a real family. Put them in the written rules you send before bidding opens — all of them, even the ones that feel unnecessary. Especially those.

No side deals during the process

While bidding is open, there are **no private trades, no 'I'll let you have the clock if you let me have the ring,' no gifts of estate items between heirs.** Every transfer goes through the bidding. Why: side deals are invisible, and invisible is the opposite of fair. The sibling who wasn't in the room for the deal will — correctly — feel cheated.

After bidding closes and the distribution agreement is signed, the items belong to their winners outright. Heirs may trade, gift, or sell among themselves freely. Your property, your business. The rule only covers the window when the process is running.

No “Mom promised me that” without proof

This sentence will be said. Possibly about the same item, by two people. Here's how to handle it fairly:

1. **Every claimed promise goes in the disputed-claims log** — who claimed it, which lot, what was supposedly promised, and what evidence exists. In writing, before bidding opens.

2. **Proof means proof:** a written note from the deceased, a witnessed statement, or corroboration from someone outside the claim. 'She told me at Christmas' with no witness is not proof — it's a memory, and memories conflict.
3. **Two clean exits:** if *all* heirs agree in writing to honor the claim, the item is set aside to the claimant — no bidding needed. If they don't all agree, the item goes through bidding like everything else, and the claimant bids like everyone else. Wanting it badly is what bids are for.
4. **The executor decides, in writing, with reasons.** Any heir can appeal — but an appeal only succeeds if *every other heir* agrees to override. One holdout keeps the executor's decision. This sounds strict; it's what keeps one disputed claim from freezing the whole estate.

The point is never to call anyone a liar. The point is that **claims without a process become fights, and claims with a process become paperwork.**

Minors and heirs who can't attend

A minor heir's parent or legal guardian bids as their **proxy** — designated in writing before bidding opens, with the proxy's name recorded on the credit ledger. An heir who lives far away, is ill, or can't participate gets **the same list, at the same time, with the same deadline**, and bids by email or phone. 'We'll catch you up later' is how out-of-town siblings get disinherited by accident.

If the executor is also an heir (the usual case), the executor's own bids go up on the board under their own name, like everyone else's — and a second person should witness the final tally. See Section 5.

What happens when someone wants out

Any heir may **sit out the bidding entirely** and take only their cash share. Their credit bank goes unused — it does not transfer to another heir, and it does not convert to cash. Sitting out is a clean choice, not a punishment: some people genuinely don't want the stuff, and the system should respect that.

One door stays open: an heir who sat out Round 1 may join the **second-chance round** for unclaimed items. Nobody gets locked out of leftovers for having skipped the main event.

Keep it all in writing



The rules email. Bid receipts. The published results. The disputed-claims log. The signed distribution agreement. **If it isn't written down, it didn't happen** — and in a dispute six months later, the family member with the email wins over the family member with the memory. Every time.

Deadline discipline

One deadline, published in advance, no extensions. When it closes, it's closed — late bids are returned unopened. This feels harsh exactly once. After that, everyone respects the process *because* it didn't bend. The moment you extend a deadline for one heir, you've told every other heir the rules are negotiable — and negotiable rules are where fights live.

A word about lawyers

Nothing in this kit is legal advice, and this section most of all: if an heir threatens legal action over a claimed promise or the process itself, **stop and call an estate attorney before the next step** — not after. A one-hour consultation is the cheapest money in the entire estate. The bidding pauses; it doesn't break.

Worked example: the Hendersons

Theory is nice. Numbers are better. Here's the whole method played out — a fictional family, real arithmetic. **The Hendersons**: three siblings dividing their late mother's twelve most-wanted items. Each heir gets **1,000 bidding credits**. Two-week open-bid window — every bid posted on the family board the day it arrived, and the executor (their brother-in-law, the neutral party Mom named) kept the board current.

Round 1 — the bids come in

The executor publishes photos and lot numbers for all twelve lots. Bids go up on the board over two weeks — anyone could raise at any time, and everyone could see the standing high on every lot. Here's where the board stood when the deadline closed:

Round 1 results

LOT-001 Grandfather clock — Mara 400, Dan **650**, Priya 100 → **Dan wins (650)**. The hot item. Dan wanted it most and paid for the privilege.

LOT-002 Cedar chest — Mara 150, Priya **200** → **Priya wins (200)**.

LOT-003 Dining table & chairs — Mara 200, Dan 200, Priya 150 → **TIE**. Open tie-break round (48 hrs): Mara **250**, Dan 210 → **Mara wins (250)**.

LOT-004 Mom's wedding ring — Mara **350**, Dan 100, Priya 300 → **Mara wins (350)**.

LOT-005 Oil painting (barn scene) — Priya **250**, Dan 120 → **Priya wins (250)**.

LOT-006 Sewing machine — Mara 120, Priya **180** → **Priya wins (180)**.

LOT-007 Tool chest — Dan **200** → **Dan wins (200)**. Only bidder.

LOT-008 China set — Priya **150**, Mara 100 → **Priya wins (150)**.

LOT-009 Rocking chair — Mara **80**, Dan 60, Priya 40 → **Mara wins (80)**.

LOT-010 Handmade quilt — Priya **120**, Mara 90 → **Priya wins (120)**.

LOT-011 Silver tea service — no bids → **goes to Round 2**.

LOT-012 Box of family photos — **shared** (see the photo rule below).

Round 2 — second chance

One lot left: the silver tea service. The executor lists it for the one-week second-chance round. Dan claims it for **40 credits**. Nothing remains unclaimed — had anything been left, it would have been sold and the proceeds split three ways.

The final accounting

Credits spent and remaining

Mara: won LOT-003 (250) + LOT-004 (350) + LOT-009 (80) = **680 spent, 320 remaining**.

Dan: won LOT-001 (650) + LOT-007 (200) + LOT-011 (40) = **890 spent, 110 remaining**.

Priya: won LOT-002 (200) + LOT-005 (250) + LOT-006 (180) + LOT-008 (150) + LOT-010 (120) = **900 spent, 100 remaining**.

Look at what actually happened. Dan ‘won’ the clock — the item everyone expected a fight over — but he spent **890 of his 1,000 credits** to do it. Nobody can say the clock was handed to him: he paid 650 for it when Mara would only pay 400 and Priya 100. Mara got the ring she cared about most. Priya walked away with five lots she genuinely wanted. Every heir spent their credits exactly where their heart was.

And the leftover credits? They expire. They were never money — they were equal shares of bidding power, and everyone got the same 1,000. The results reflect what each person valued, not who argued best.

The photo rule

LOT-012, the box of family photos, was never going to be ‘won.’ The rule: one sibling keeps the originals and **scans everything, sharing digital copies with all siblings within 60 days** — the deadline goes in the distribution agreement. If no one wants the keeper job, the executor has them scanned professionally and splits the cost. Originals of truly one-of-a-kind photos can rotate yearly if the family wants. Decide this **before** bidding opens so photos never become a contested lot.

The executor publishes all of this — every lot, every bid, every winner — to all three siblings at once. Mara, Dan, and Priya each sign the distribution agreement. Done: one weekend of inventory, two weeks of bidding, one afternoon of paperwork. No lawyers. No lingering resentment. That’s the system working as designed.

The executor as neutral auctioneer

Running the bidding is the most visible thing you'll do as executor — and the easiest to get wrong. Your job description is short: **publish the list, send the rules, post every bid in the open, enforce the deadline, publish the results, keep the records.** Neutral, boring, meticulous. The best auctioneer is the one nobody notices.

Your role, precisely

- **You publish.** The inventory goes out to every heir at the same time, in the same form. No previews, no 'just between us' early looks.
- **You collect — and you post.** Every bid comes to you, and goes up on the board the same day, with the bidder's name on it. Confirm every bid in writing the day it arrives — 'received and posted your bids for LOT-003 and LOT-004' — so nothing can later be called lost, and nobody has to wonder what the standing bids are.
- **You enforce.** The deadline is the deadline. Late bids come back unopened. Exceptions require *every* heir's written agreement, or they don't happen.
- **You publish again.** Full results to everyone at once: every lot, every winner, every winning bid, every tie-break. Then the updated credit ledgers. Sunlight, every time.
- **You keep the paper.** Bid sheets, results, the claims log, the signed agreement — filed together, kept for years. If anyone ever questions the process, the file answers.

Your boundaries

- **Never hold a bid back.** The board is only fair if it's current — a bid sitting unseen in your inbox while everyone else bids against stale numbers is the one way to poison an open process. Post everything the day it arrives. If you genuinely can't, say so on the board and post it the next morning.
- **Never freelance the rules.** If a situation comes up the rules don't cover, you have two options: handle it exactly the way the written rules say, or get every heir's written agreement to a change. There is no third option where you decide alone.
- **Don't lobby.** Don't tell your sister the ring 'would mean a lot to Mom.' Don't tell your brother to go easy. Your opinions about who should get what are the one thing in this process that doesn't count.

- **If you bid, bid like everyone else.** Most executors are also heirs — that's normal. Your bids go up on the board under your own name, at the same time as everyone else's — never early, never late. Have a second person witness the final tally; it costs nothing and ends the question before it's asked.
- **Don't take the heat personally.** Someone may still be unhappy — with an outcome, with a tie-break, with you. That's grief talking, not the process failing. Point at the written rules, show the numbers, stay kind, stay firm.

When the auctioneer needs backup

If an heir accuses you of bias, threatens legal action, or refuses to accept published results — **pause the process and call an estate attorney.** Do not argue your way through it; you cannot be both a party to a dispute and its referee. The bidding waits. It doesn't break.

Executor's setup checklist

Run this list before the bidding window opens. Every box checked is a fight that can't happen.

- ☐ **Inventory complete.** Every item photographed, lot-numbered, condition-noted, and on the inventory sheet. Nothing has left the house.
- ☐ **List published to all heirs at the same time.** Same photos, same descriptions, same moment. No early access for anyone.
- ☐ **Rules sent in writing to every heir.** Deadline, open bids posted where every heir can see them, tie-break rule, no side deals, the 'promised items' policy, what happens to leftovers.
- ☐ **Credit banks set and recorded.** 1,000 credits per heir (or proportional to shares — stated in the rules). Entered on the per-heir credit ledger.
- ☐ **Bid sheets ready.** Round bid sheets prepared; the deadline is on everyone's calendar and in the rules email.
- ☐ **Proxies designated in writing.** Minor heirs' guardians and absent heirs' arrangements recorded before bidding opens.
- ☐ **Disputed-claims log open.** Any 'Mom promised me that' claims logged and resolved *before* the affected lots are bid on.



Results template ready. You know exactly what the results announcement will look like — because you've already drafted it.

Your logo / letterhead here

Item Inventory Sheet

One row per lot. Nothing leaves until it is photographed, numbered, and on this list.

[illegible]

Your logo / letterhead here

Item Inventory Sheet

One row per lot. Nothing leaves until it is photographed, numbered, and on this list. (contin

[illegible]

Your logo / letterhead here

Per-Heir Credit Ledger

One row per heir. Credits are bidding power — equal banks, same rules for everyone.

Estate of

Executor

Date bidding opens

Heir name	Credits issued	Round 1 spent	Round 2 spent	Remaining	Initials

Proxies (minor/absent heirs): record guardian or proxy name and authority here.

Proxy designations

Your logo / letterhead here

Round Bid Sheet

Open bids — posted where every heir can see them. One sheet per heir per round.

Round #

Bidder name

Bidding deadline

[illegible]

Your logo / letterhead here

Round Bid Sheet

Open bids — posted where every heir can see them. One sheet per heir per round. (contin

Round #

Bidder name

Bidding deadline

[illegible]

Your logo / letterhead here

Results and Tally Sheet

Published to every heir at the same time when bidding closes.

[illegible]

Results published (date)

Certified by (executor)



Final Distribution Agreement

Each heir signs below, confirming what they received. Every heir gets a copy.

We, the undersigned heirs, confirm that the personal property listed below was distributed according to the family bidding process, that we had equal opportunity to bid, and that the results were published to all of us. We accept the distribution as final.

Heir 1

Name (print)

Credits spent

Cash adj. \$

Items received (lot numbers and descriptions):

Signature

Date

Heir 2

Name (print)

Credits spent

Cash adj. \$

Items received (lot numbers and descriptions):

Signature

Date

Heir 3

Name (print)

Credits spent

Cash adj. \$

Items received (lot numbers and descriptions):

Signature

Date



Final Distribution Agreement

continued — each heir signs below.

Heir 4

Name (print)

Credits spent

Cash adj. \$

Items received (lot numbers and descriptions):

Signature

Date

Heir 5

Name (print)

Credits spent

Cash adj. \$

Items received (lot numbers and descriptions):

Signature

Date

Heir 6

Name (print)

Credits spent

Cash adj. \$

Items received (lot numbers and descriptions):

Signature

Date

Your logo / letterhead here

Disputed-Claims Log

"Mom promised me that" — every claim in writing, with evidence and a resolution.

#	Claimant	Item / lot #	Claim (what was promised)	Evidence?	Resolution
				☐	
				☐	
				☐	
				☐	
				☐	
				☐	
				☐	
				☐	
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Evidence = written note, witnessed statement, or outside corroboration. 'She told me' alone is not evidence.

Decided by (executor)

Date

You kept the family together.

Dividing a loved one's belongings is one of the hardest things a family does — not because of the objects, but because of everything the objects carry.

If you ran a fair process, showed your work, and treated everyone the same, you did it right. Years from now, nobody will remember who got the lamp. They'll remember that it was fair.

That's what the person you lost would have wanted.

An organizational tool. Not legal advice, not tax advice.
Thank you for trusting this kit. — Bill